followed in Addis Ababa in 2011.) In practice, while India's engagement with Africa increased, it was more focused on eastern and southern Africa, which benefited from historical ties, Indian communities, geographical proximity, and economic dynamism. In addition to the ASEAN Summit, India also engaged the five Central Asian Republics and later the Nordic countries at the leadership level. India–EU Summits, which had been held with leaders of Brussels-based institutions since 2000, were complemented by a hybrid Leaders' Meeting in 2021. In each of these cases, discussions focused on what India could offer including in terms of investment, technology, or market access, and in turn how it could benefit from regional partnerships to source commodities, financing, and political goodwill.

Perhaps the most radical new relationships in this period were forged in West Asia (the Middle East). Hosting Abu Dhabi's crown prince (and later president of the United Arab Emirates) Sheikh Mohammed bin Zayed Al Nahyan (popularly referred to as MbZ), for Republic Day in 2017 contributed to major breakthroughs in India's relations with the United Arab Emirates and Gulf States. On regional issues, there was a meeting of the minds and shared concerns about radical Islamism. Outreach to the UAE also facilitated better relations with Saudi Arabia, which for many years had been a close partner of Pakistan. Regional developments following the 'Arab Spring' and the economic imperatives had gradually elevated India's importance for the Gulf Arab states. The relationship between India and the Gulf was no longer about just the diaspora and fossil fuel energy exports, but increasingly also about trade, investment, technology, security, and education. [33] The sizeable Indian diaspora also helped ensure strong cultural links, including the building and inauguration by Modi of a temple—BAPS Hindu Mandir—in Abu Dhabi in early 2024. In other regional developments, Modi also used his political capital to further elevate relations with Israel. In 2017, Modi became the first Indian prime minister to visit Israel, following reciprocal visits by the two countries' presidents.

A final major development of Modi's first term involved shifts on nuclear and climate diplomacy. As part of capitalizing on the India–US civilian nuclear agreement, India became a member of the Missile Technology